

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.1: The Grammar Bridge

Distinguish form from function and begin a Latin clause map before translating

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	Fluent English; familiarity with subject, verb, object, and modifier; no prior Latin grammar
Next	EL-I.2, Case, Number, Gender, and Agreement

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 1: From English Grammar to Latin Forms

On completing this unit, you can:

- distinguish a clause, subject, finite verb, direct object, predicate complement, modifier, and prepositional phrase;
- explain why Latin endings, rather than position alone, identify a word's work; and
- expand the dictionary forms of a noun, adjective, ordinary verb, deponent verb, and pronoun into usable grammatical information.

1.1 The English bridge

A **clause** makes an assertion, asks a question, or expresses a command. Its **subject** is what the clause is about; its **finite verb** is marked for person and number and anchors the clause. A **transitive verb** is one whose construction can take a direct object. A **direct object** is the noun, pronoun, or noun-equivalent selected by that verb without a preposition; it may name what is affected, perceived, produced, possessed, or otherwise directly involved in the event. A **predicate complement** completes a linking verb by identifying or describing the subject: a predicate noun identifies it, while a predicate adjective describes it. In “the priest reads the prayer,” “the priest” is the subject, “reads” is the finite verb, and “the prayer” is the direct object. In “the prayer is holy,” “holy” is a predicate adjective linked to the subject by “is”. A **modifier** limits or describes another word; a **prepositional phrase** begins with a preposition and includes the preposition's object and its modifiers.

The five labels on a finite verb answer different questions. **Person** identifies speaker (first), addressee (second), or someone or something else (third). **Number** distinguishes singular from plural. **Tense** locates or presents the action in time. **Voice** shows whether the subject acts or receives the action. **Mood** presents the action as a statement, command, wish, possibility, or another kind of utterance. These labels describe the Latin form; an idiomatic English translation may express them differently.

English normally signals these relations by word order and helper words. Latin can signal them by **inflection**: a controlled change in a word's form, usually its ending, that marks grammatical information. Thus *Deus amat hominem* and *hominem amat Deus* both mean “God loves the human being”. The endings *-us* and *-em*, not first and last position, identify subject and object. Word order still matters for emphasis and rhythm, but it is not the first parsing tool.

A five-question first pass

For every finite clause ask, in this order: (1) What is the finite verb? (2) What person, number, tense, voice, and mood does its ending show? (3) What nominative word agrees with its number and can be its subject? (4) Which remaining forms are required by the verb or a preposition? (5) Which words agree with, possess, or modify those forms? Do not translate until each visible ending has a proposed job.

1.2 What a dictionary entry promises

A dictionary's **citation form** is the conventional form under which a word is listed. The additional forms printed with it are not optional variants: they reveal information that the first form alone cannot supply. A **stem** is the stable base to which endings are added. A verb's **principal parts** are its listed forms from which the major stems and systems can be recovered. In the noun entries below, the **nominative** is the headword and usual subject form, while the **genitive** is the "of" form that reveals the stem and declension. **Gender** is the noun's grammatical class (masculine, feminine, or neuter), which controls agreement. A **declension** is a noun's pattern of case endings; a **conjugation** is the corresponding inflectional pattern for a verb.

Kind	Citation form	Information supplied
Noun	<i>gloria, gloriæ f.</i>	nominative singular, genitive singular, gender; the genitive reveals declension and stem
Adjective	<i>sanctus, sancta, sanctum</i>	nominative singular forms for masculine, feminine, and neuter
Third-declension adjective	<i>omnis, omne</i>	masculine/feminine and neuter nominative singular; genitive is <i>omnis</i>
Verb	<i>laudo, laudare, laudavi, laudatum</i>	first-person present, present infinitive, first-person perfect, and supine/perfect-participle base
Deponent verb	<i>sequor, sequi, secutus sum</i>	present form, infinitive, and perfect form; passive morphology but active meaning
Pronoun	<i>hic, hæc, hoc</i>	masculine, feminine, and neuter nominative singular forms

Never guess a noun's stem from the nominative alone. Remove *-is* from its genitive singular: *regis* gives *reg-*; *corporis* gives *corpor-*. For a regular verb, the infinitive identifies its conjugation. Perfect stems, however, must normally be learned from the third principal part: *rego, regere, rexi* has perfect stem *rex-*, not **regiv-*.

Worked example: *In principio erat Verbum* (Jn 1:1)

Worked passage ID: *W.I.1*; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Form	Dictionary form	Morphology	Function	Sense here
<i>erat</i>	<i>sum, esse, fui</i>	3rd singular, imperfect active indicative	finite verb	was

The finite verb comes before its grammatical subject.

Form	Dictionary form	Morphology	Function	Sense here
<i>Verbum</i>	<i>verbum, -i n.</i>	nominative singular neuter	subject	the Word

The capital is helpful, but the nominative ending supplies the syntax. *in* governs the ablative *principio*, "in the beginning". Translation: "In the beginning was the Word."

Worked example: *Dominus vobiscum* (Mass dialogue)

Worked passage ID: W.I.2; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Dominus is nominative singular, “the Lord”. *vobiscum* is *cum vobis*: *cum* is attached after the personal pronoun, and *vobis* is ablative plural, “with you”. The formula is conventionally construed as a wish; *[sit]* is an interpretive expansion, not a printed or uniquely required form. Translation: “The Lord be with you.” The response *Et cum spiritu tuo* is likewise an elliptical phrase: *spiritu* and *tuo* are ablative singular.

Worked example: *Deo gratias* (Mass conclusion)

Worked passage ID: W.I.3; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Deo is dative singular, the recipient “to God”. *gratias* is accusative plural, “thanks”, the object of an understood expression such as *agimus*, “we give”. Idiomatic translation: “Thanks be to God.” The two visible nouns are not a subject–verb sentence; supplied English words must not be mistaken for Latin forms actually present.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition

In ink, diagram five English clauses of increasing complexity and mark subject, finite verb, object or complement, every modifier, and every prepositional phrase. Then copy the three Latin examples above twice. On the first copy, underline finite verbs; on the second, write the dictionary form and proposed function over every word. Finally compose, from the supplied vocabulary, *Deus amat hominem*, “God loves the human being”, and rearrange it in two ways without changing the endings or the basic meaning.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The English bridge — transfer practice

Connection. The same visible word can fill different sentence jobs, so a neutral clause map protects the learner from importing English order into Latin.

Transfer task. Make a four-column map for *Deum laudat Maria*: printed form, possible morphology, contextual function, and evidence. Then reorder the Latin twice without changing the roles.

Retrieval check. Without notes, define *form* and *function* and give one example in which first position does not mark the subject.

1.2 Orthography without a pronunciation course — transfer practice

Connection. Edition typography can change the page's appearance without changing the underlying form or syntax.

Transfer task. Normalize *JESVS*, *EVANGELIVM*, *praeceptum* to the course house style, then annotate which changes are graphic and which, if any, affect grammatical analysis.

Retrieval check. State why capitalization, *i/j*, *u/v*, and *æ/ae* cannot by themselves assign subject or object.

1.3 What a dictionary entry promises — transfer practice

Connection. A headword is a compressed paradigm, not merely a translation label.

Transfer task. Expand *rex*, *regis m.*, *omnis*, *omne*, and *sequor*, *sequi*, *secutus sum* into the minimum facts needed to recognize unfamiliar forms.

Retrieval check. For each part of speech, name the listed part that reveals the stem or inflectional system.

1.4 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. Copying becomes useful only when it forces retrieval, comparison, and correction rather than visual imitation.

Transfer task. Copy one lesson clause, cover it, reconstruct it from a clause map, and mark every difference between the reconstruction and the source as form, order, spelling, or omitted content.

Retrieval check. Explain why a corrected full sentence is more diagnostic than copying one isolated ending.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 1: The Grammar Bridge

Worksheet I.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.1

Focus: Clause roles, dictionary forms, and first reading habits**Use:** Use independently after the unit; write every requested label, not only a translation.

1. Copy *Dominus custodit animam*. Underline the subject once, the finite verb twice, and box the direct object. Then give the neutral English order.

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2. Label each entry noun, verb, or adjective and state what its listed parts tell you: *Deus*, *Dei m.*; *gratia*, *gratiæ f.*; *laudo*, *laudare*, *laudavi*, *laudatum*; *sanctus*, *-a*, *-um*.

-
3. Rewrite *Deum laudamus* in subject–verb–object order. Explain why the meaning does not change.

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4. In “The eternal Word guards our souls”, name the subject, finite verb, object, and every modifier.

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5. Translate *Deo gratias*. State what may be supplied to make a full Latin clause.

-
6. **Text:** *In principio erat Verbum*.

Passage ID: I.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Mark the prepositional phrase, finite verb, and subject; then translate.

Worksheet I.4 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.4**Focus:** Dictionary literacy, word order, and close translation**Use:** This variant tests the same gate with different words.

1. Analyze “Our Father grants eternal life to the faithful”: identify subject, finite verb, direct object, recipient, and modifiers.

2. Classify the listed information in *corpus*, *corporis n.*; *credo*, *credere*, *credidi*, *creditum*; *æternus*, *-a*, *-um*.

-
3. For printed *GLORIA IN EXCELSIS DEO*, write the course form and state why capitalization does not supply grammatical roles.

-
4. Copy *Te laudamus*. Supply its unprinted subject, name the object, and translate.

-
5. Diagnose this reading error: “The first noun in *Deum laudat Maria* must be the subject.” Give the correct analysis.

-
6. **Text:** *Deo gratias. Amen.*

Passage ID: I.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

This course composite places two independent liturgical responses together; separate their syntax and give each sense.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Identify every finite verb, subject, object or complement, and modifier in a fresh simple clause; recover usable information from representative dictionary entries; and explain one printed-versus-supplied-word decision without relying on remembered English.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.2, Case, Number, Gender, and Agreement.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.2 and I.3 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The English bridge — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. A complete map identifies *Deum* as accusative object, *laudat* as third-person singular finite verb, and *Maria* as nominative subject. Accept any two grammatical reorderings that preserve those endings. The retrieval answer must make endings and clause government—not position—the deciding evidence.

Orthography without a pronunciation course — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The course forms are *Iesus*, *Evangelium*, *præceptum*. All named changes are graphic here; none assigns a clause function. A sound answer says that endings, agreement, and government decide the parse.

What a dictionary entry promises — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. For *rex*, the genitive reveals stem *reg-* and gender is masculine; *omnis*, *omne* identifies a two-termination third-declension adjective; *sequor* supplies a deponent present infinitive and perfect participial principal part. Merely giving English glosses does not satisfy the task.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The reconstruction must preserve the original proposition and grammatical relations. A defensible explanation says that a full sentence retests agreement, government, and clause structure together, while an isolated ending may conceal the source of the error.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 1: The Grammar Bridge

Solution I.1 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.1

Focus: Clause roles, dictionary forms, and first reading habits

Use: Use independently after the unit; write every requested label, not only a translation.

1. Copy *Dominus custodit animam*. Underline the subject once, the finite verb twice, and box the direct object. Then give the neutral English order.
Answer / model: Subject: *Dominus*; finite verb: *custodit*; direct object: *animam*. “The Lord guards the soul.”
2. Label each entry noun, verb, or adjective and state what its listed parts tell you: *Deus*, *Dei m.*; *gratia*, *gratiæ f.*; *laudo*, *laudare*, *laudavi*, *laudatum*; *sanctus*, *-a*, *-um*.
Answer / model: *Deus* and *gratia* are nouns; nominative, genitive, and gender are supplied. *Laudo* is a verb; its four principal parts are supplied. *Sanctus* is an adjective; its masculine, feminine, and neuter nominative singular forms are supplied.
3. Rewrite *Deum laudamus* in subject–verb–object order. Explain why the meaning does not change.
Answer / model: *Nos laudamus Deum*. With the normally omitted subject pronoun, *Laudamus Deum* preserves the verb–object sequence but no longer displays all three requested positions. Verb ending *-mus* identifies “we”; *Deum* remains the object regardless of position.
4. In “The eternal Word guards our souls”, name the subject, finite verb, object, and every modifier.
Answer / model: Subject: “Word”; finite verb: “guards”; object: “souls”; “the” and “eternal” modify “Word”; “our” modifies “souls”.
5. Translate *Deo gratias*. State what may be supplied to make a full Latin clause.
Answer / model: “Thanks be to God.” *Deo* is the recipient; *gratias* means “thanks”. A close Latin expansion may supply *[agimus]* or *[agamus]*. The word “be” belongs to the conventional English rendering and is not an omitted Latin copula.
6. **Text:** *In principio erat Verbum*.
Passage ID: I.1.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Mark the prepositional phrase, finite verb, and subject; then translate.
Answer / notes: Prepositional phrase: *in principio*; finite verb: *erat*; subject: *Verbum*. “In the beginning was the Word.”

Solution I.4 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.4

Focus: Dictionary literacy, word order, and close translation

Use: This variant tests the same gate with different words.

1. Analyze “Our Father grants eternal life to the faithful”: identify subject, finite verb, direct object, recipient, and modifiers.
Answer / model: Subject: “Father”; finite verb: “grants”; direct object: “life”; recipient: “the faithful”; “our” modifies “Father”; “eternal” modifies “life”.
2. Classify the listed information in *corpus*, *corporis n.*; *credo*, *credere*, *credidi*, *creditum*; *aeternus*, *-a*, *-um*.
Answer / model: *Corpus* is a neuter noun with nominative and genitive; *credo* is a verb with four principal parts; *aeternus* is a three-termination adjective giving masculine, feminine, and neuter nominative singular.
3. For printed *GLORIA IN EXCELSIS DEO*, write the course form and state why capitalization does not supply grammatical roles.
Answer / model: *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. Capitals are a typographic choice; the endings and syntax, not letter case, show relationships.
4. Copy *Te laudamus*. Supply its unprinted subject, name the object, and translate.
Answer / model: The verb ending supplies subject *nos*, “we”; *te* is the object. “We praise you.”
5. Diagnose this reading error: “The first noun in *Deum laudat Maria* must be the subject.” Give the correct analysis.
Answer / model: Latin need not put the subject first. *Deum* is the object, *laudat* is the finite verb, and *Maria* is the subject: “Mary praises God.”
6. **Text:** *Deo gratias. Amen.*
Passage ID: I.4.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 This course composite places two independent liturgical responses together; separate their syntax and give each sense.
Answer / notes: *Deo gratias* is an elliptical expression, “Thanks be to God”; *Amen* is an indeclinable acclamation, “Amen” or “truly/so be it”. They are not presented as one continuous received source passage.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.1, *The Grammar Bridge*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This opening packet establishes method rather than claiming broad reading competence.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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